Eleanor's Tavern Shop - Photo Standard

What a shot has to clear before it goes on a listing, and what to check on the listings already up. Written after the spring returns run. Ellen, August 2026.

1. A shot is usable when all four hold

Check	Standard
Focus	Sharp on the product. If the piece will not read at a glance, it is a reshoot.
Exposure	Evenly lit, reads at full colour. Dark and muddy is a reshoot, not a fix in edit.
Backdrop	Plain and uncluttered, no props, the piece clear of the background.
Framing	One piece per shot, square to the camera, no second product beside it.

A shot fails on any one of the four. Three good checks and one bad check is still a reshoot. Say which check it failed when you send it back, or it comes back the same.

2. The listing photo has to match the listing copy

Every live listing gets read against its own photo. Count what is in the picture against what the title says is in the box. Read the colour in the picture against the colour in the description. This is where the returns come from: the copy promises one thing, the photo shows another, and the customer believes the photo.

3. Performance is not a photo check

A listing that sells well has not been checked. It has only sold well. Views, favourites, and order volume say nothing about whether the photo matches the copy. The instinct is to leave the strong listing alone and go poke at the quiet ones. That is backwards. A mismatch on the listing that moves is the expensive one, because it ships the most boxes and it earns the most returns.

Do not rank the audit by views. Check every live listing against its photo, the strong ones included, and report what you find on each.

4. Who changes what

Flag it, do not fix it. Nothing is pulled from the shop, no listing copy is edited, and no price moves without Carlton. He has been clear that the shop is small enough that he wants to see every change before it goes live.

Eleanor's Tavern shop - Etsy storefront - questions to Ellen.